Project 6 Tips

How to type lowercase in DDS code in PDM/SEU

Shift F1 (F13) takes you to "session defaults" where we can put an N on the "upper case only" entry, thus allowing us to type our DDS in lower case

Standalone Character Variables

Many of the tasks in this program necessitate defining standalone character fields to hold your results and then assigning the manipulated data to these new fields.

Trimming

"Trimming" will be necessary.

Using Substring

Consider this scenario as an example:

Let's say we have a "scrambled" SSN that we want to "rearrange"

SSN is a numeric field in this example, so first I must convert it to a character field

I make up a name for this new field and make it a standalone variable using DCL-S, such as

```
Dcl-s SSNCHAR Char(9);
```

Next, I define a character field to hold my rearranged data with inserted dashes. Such as SSNFINAL length of 11

```
Dcl-s SSNFINAL Char(11);
```

Next, I use substring to "pull out" characters and then put it all back together with concatenation.

So, in my example the "scrambled" SSN currently is a number holding

```
678945123
```

and my desired outcome is

```
123-45-6789
```

Step 1: convert SSN to a character field that I declared as SSNCHAR

```
SSNCHAR = %char(SSN);
```

Step 2: use substring, combined with concatenation to rearrange my data. Study substring on in your text first. So I want to "pull out" the last 3 digits, insert a dash, "pull out" the middle two digits (the 4 and 5) , insert a dash" and then "pull out" the first 4 digits....

```
SSNFINAL = %Subst(SSNCHAR:7:3) + '-' + %Subst(SSNCHAR:5:2) + '-' +
%Subst(SSNCHAR:1:4);
```

pull out three characters starting with the 7th character, concatenate a dash, concatenate with the two characters I pulled out starting with position 5, concatenate a dash, concatenate that with the 4 characters I pulled out beginning with position 1... voila!